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5 AI Coding Tools Developers Are Using That Nobody Talks About

Forget ChatGPT and Copilot. These underrated tools can change how you code.

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Gopi C K

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AI coding has changed much faster than most developers expected. A few years ago, using AI for programming mostly meant copying a question into a chatbot, waiting for an answer, copying the generated code into an editor, and hoping everything worked. Today, that workflow is becoming much more powerful because a new generation of AI coding tools can understand repositories, inspect files, modify multiple parts of a project, execute commands, work with Git, run tests, and participate directly inside the developer workflow.

Most developers already know the names that dominate the conversation. ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Claude, and similar tools are frequently discussed on social media, YouTube, newsletters, and developer communities. There is nothing wrong with using them, but the interesting part of the AI coding ecosystem is happening beyond those familiar names. Several smaller or open source tools are giving developers much more control over models, repositories, terminals, local AI, automation, and development environments.

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Writing about software engineering, coding, system design, AI, and the lessons I wish I'd learned sooner.

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